

Germany, as well as Venice. Her success as a prolific female composer was due to her tenacity, shrewdness in business, and scant regard for what was deemed respectable for women of her day. Far from concealing her identity behind a male pseudonym—a tactic used by many women who wanted their voices to be heard—she put her name to all her works.

Strozzi lived most of her life in Venice but died in Padua in 1677. Her popularity waned after her death and the details of her life and work were largely relegated to obscurity until the 1990s, when they were recuperated by feminist scholars interested in understanding her achievements in the context of the uncompromisingly patriarchal environment of 17th-century Venice.

“ Being **a woman** I am concerned about **publishing this work**. Would that it ... **not be** endangered by the **swords of slander**. ”

BARBARA STROZZI, ON THE PUBLICATION OF HER
FIRST BOOK OF MADRIGALS IN 1644